



Discussion Guide: Miroslav Volf

Why Did God Create the World? And Why We Need to Know

Reflect

- Miroslav claims that God's central purpose in creation is to make the world a "home" for everyone, rich and poor alike. What resonates with you about this understanding of the purpose of creation? What questions does it raise?
- The first home-destroying force that Miroslav identifies is reification, which is the treatment of people, creatures, and creation as "things" which can be manipulated. Where do you see examples of this today and what problems does it cause in your own community?
- The second home-destroying force that Miroslav identifies is escalation, which is the push to keep moving faster and faster and yet always feeling behind. Where do you see this in your own life? What worries, fears, or beliefs drive you toward escalation, even if it leaves you feeling depleted?

Respond

- Describe a time in life when you felt "at home." Where were you and what enabled you to feel at home in that place?
- Choose the story of the Good Samaritan (Luke 10:25-37) OR the story of manna and quail (Exodus 16:1-36). In what ways is this story about someone feeling homeless? What does the text teach us about the actions or attitudes needed to create a deeper sense of at-homeness for everyone in the community?
- What is one concrete thing you, your church, or your neighborhood could do to help others feel more "at home" in your community?